

# THE DEMOGRAPHIC SHIFT

- 1 **50% OF INDIA'S ORGANISED WORKFORCE IS 45 YEARS OR OLDER**
- 2 **ONE IN FIVE EMPLOYEES COULD BE 50+ BY 2030. OLDER EMPLOYEES REMAIN AMONG THE MOST COMMITTED WORKERS IN THE LABOUR FORCE**
- 3 **LONGER LIFE EXPECTANCY AND FINANCIAL REALITIES ARE EXTENDING CAREERS WELL BEYOND TRADITIONAL RETIREMENT AGE**
- 4 **WHILE ORGANISATIONS INCREASINGLY VALUE EXPERIENCED PROFESSIONALS, DEMAND VARIES WIDELY ACROSS SECTORS**
- 5 **AGE BIAS TODAY IS RARELY EXPLICIT BUT IS OFTEN EXPRESSED AS A CONCERN AROUND 'ENERGY'**



aspirations, that model is becoming increasingly outdated,” says Ravi.

Rather than retirement planning, Ravi advocates “life progression planning,” where the focus shifts from stopping work to continuing to grow, contribute and find purpose.

She believes one of the biggest misconceptions about experienced professionals is that they are less adaptable or less interested in learning. “Most experienced professionals have already adapted through multiple waves of technological change—from computers and the internet to smartphones and cloud platforms. AI is another significant shift, but it is not the first,” she says.

Ravi believes one of the biggest misconceptions about experienced professionals is that they are less adaptable or less interested in learning. Most have already navigated multiple waves of technological change from computers and the internet to smartphones and cloud platforms. AI is simply the next transition, not the first. “What worries many people more is not learning new technology, but the fear of becoming less relevant,” she says.

Rather than viewing generations in competition, she sees them as complementary. Younger professionals bring digital fluency, curiosity and fresh perspectives, while AI adds analytical capability. Experienced professionals contribute judgement, context and perspective.

“The organisations that succeed,” she argues, “will be those that combine the innovation of younger employees, the judgement of experienced professionals and the analytical power of AI.”

## THE CONFIDENCE GAP

Older employees remain among the most committed workers in the labour force. According to ADP’s People at Work report, workers aged 55 and above are just as likely as younger colleagues to find meaning in their work, report high levels of engagement and least likely to be planning to quit.

Yet that commitment is not matched by confidence about the future. Confidence about career progression steadily declines with age, regardless of education level. Among college-educated employees aged 18 to 26, nearly one in three (32%) strongly believe they have the skills needed to move to the next level in their careers. That falls to 27% among employees aged 40–54, 22% among those aged 55–64 and 23% among workers aged 65 and above.

The decline extends beyond self-belief. Only 13% of college-educated workers aged 55–64 and 14% of those aged 65 and above strongly believe their employer is investing in the skills they